



Arnab Roy
GM - Marketing
Sun Microsystems India

“At Sun, the first step in being eco-responsible is the “greening” of our business, or minimising the environmental impact of our operations. We are determined to integrate eco principles into every aspect of our operations. We will implement a thin-client IT architecture, where processing takes place on the network. In all, Sun has facilities to significantly reduce both power and materials consumption. We are making data centres smaller and more energy-efficient so they will emit less carbon and cost less.

It is definitely feasible and absolutely necessary for others to take such steps. A joint effort by all the companies in the industry will go a long way in ensuring that the negative impact on our environment is minimised. Efforts by one or two corporates will have limited impact.

There has been recent research by IIT Delhi along with Sun India, and according to their recommendations, the Government should enforce energy conservation steps by IT communities such as tax incentives and guidelines that motivate computer professionals to purchase energy-efficient components, foster voluntary industry efforts to develop energy-efficient computing products, and engage in public / private partnerships that highlight the cost benefits of energy-efficient data centres.



COMPANIES

What are technology companies doing to be environment-friendly? Should the Government enforce policies on them to make them go along those lines?



Rahul Bedi
Director, Corporate Affairs
Intel South Asia and India
Business Operations
Manager

“Intel takes various steps to ensure environment-friendly computing. At our conference centre in Bangalore, we have motion detectors that switch off lights when no one has been in the room for more than ten minutes. We don’t have Desktop computers at Intel—laptops consume less electricity, which again is good for the environment. We have stringent e-disposal policies applicable at our offices the world over. Before we dispose of a computer, we see if it can be used in other departments. If it isn’t, we donate it to an NGO. If the computers are not working at all, we scrap them with a vendor who adheres to our stringent disposal policies.

Every corporation should have policies for environmentally-friendly computing: disregarding this will come back in the form of deteriorating employee health, increase in costs, and so on. Yes, there is an investment required, but it pays off in the long run.

The government should have policies pertaining to this, but organisations should follow environment-friendly practices regardless. In addition, making employees aware of the big picture of their actions helps more than dictating policies.”